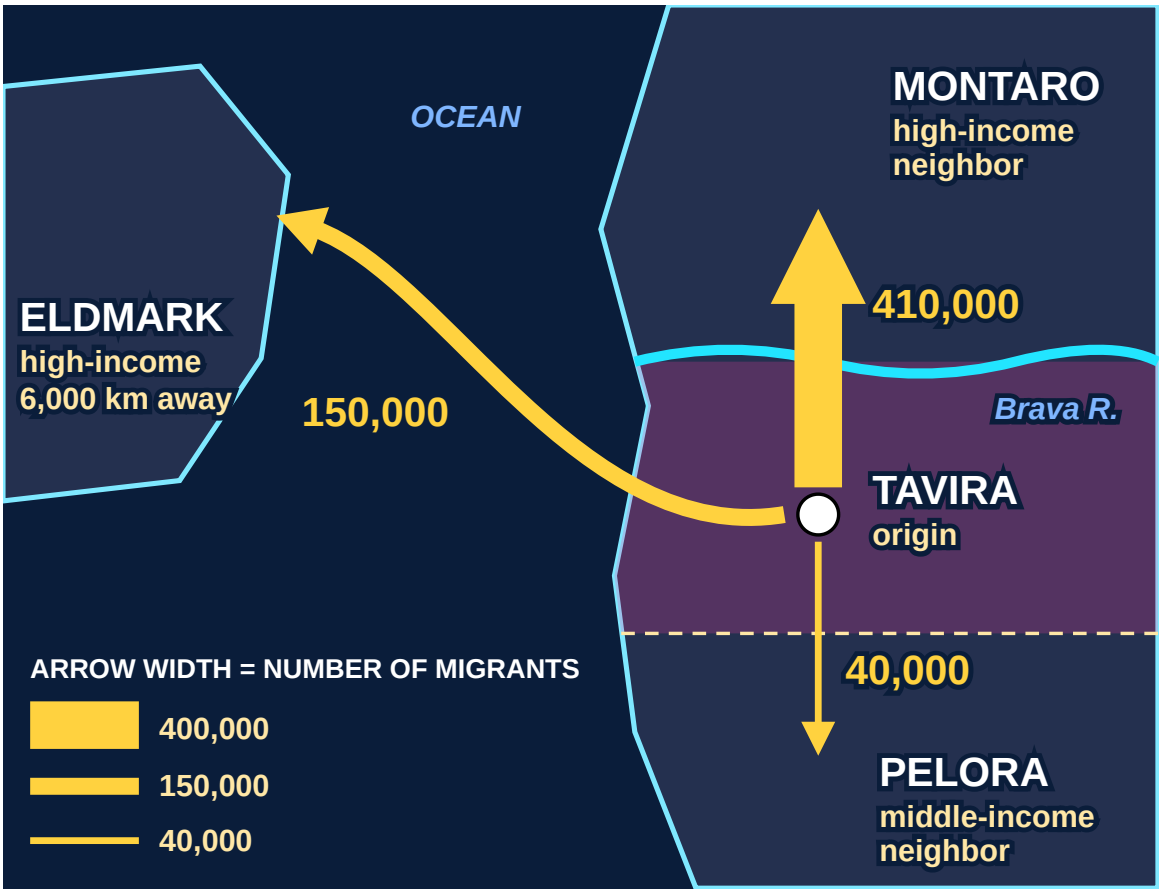
On the Move

AP Human Geography · Unit 2 · Two stimuli (like Question 3) · 7 points · Teacher key · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

Stimulus 1 is a flow map of the people who left the country of Tavira in 2023. Stimulus 2 is one of those migrants describing her move in her own words. (Tavira, its neighbors, the numbers, and the person are fictional and were created for practice.)

Stimulus 1: Emigration from Tavira, 2023



Flow map created for practice. Tavira, Montaro, Eldmark, Pelora, and all numbers are fictional. Tavira's population is about 20 million. Schematic, not to scale.

Stimulus 2: "Why I Left Tavira"

"The drought lasted three years. Our maize died, and the family farm could not feed us anymore. My cousin Elena had already lived in Montaro for six years. She found me a job at the fruit-packing plant where she works. Getting here was the hardest part: we crossed the Brava River at night, where people drown every year, and then walked for hours along the border wall to find a way through. Now I send money home every month so my little brothers can stay in school. Someday, when the rains return, I will go back to Tavira."

Account by Marisol, age 24, who moved from Tavira to Montaro in 2023. Marisol and her words are fictional and were created for practice.

A. Identify ONE environmental push factor described in Stimulus 2. IDENTIFY

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ANY ONE OF THESE:

- Drought / lack of rain
- Crop failure on the family farm

MODEL ANSWER

A drought that lasted three years and killed the maize on Marisol's family farm.

Common mistake: “She wanted to make more money.” That's economic, and it's really a pull toward Montaro. The question asks for an ENVIRONMENTAL push: something in nature that drove her away.

Why the model works: It names an environmental push (the drought) and ties it to passage details (three years, dead maize).

B. Using Stimulus 1, describe the pattern of migration from Tavira and how it reflects the role of distance in migration. DESCRIBE

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Describes the pattern: most went a short distance to neighboring Montaro
- Uses map evidence: numbers or arrow widths (410,000 vs. 150,000)
- Connects to distance: distance decay or Ravenstein

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Most migrants from Tavira moved a short distance to a neighboring country, and far fewer made the long trip overseas.
E2- In 2023, 410,000 people went next door to Montaro, while only 150,000 crossed the ocean to Eldmark, about 6,000 km away, even though both are high-income countries.
A3- This fits Ravenstein's law that most migrants move short distances, an example of distance decay: long moves cost more and feel riskier, so fewer people make them.

Common mistake: “Most people went to Montaro.” It names the pattern but stops: no numbers and no link to distance. Add 410,000 vs. 150,000 and explain why distance matters.

Why the model works: It describes the pattern (most went next door), proves it with map numbers, and links it to Ravenstein and distance decay.

C. Using Stimulus 2, explain how Marisol's move is an example of chain migration. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Shows what chain migration is: following family or people from home who already moved
- Uses the passage: cousin Elena already lived there and found her a job
- Explains how the link helped cause the move

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Marisol's move is chain migration because she followed a family member who had already settled in Montaro.
E2- Her cousin Elena had lived there for six years and found Marisol a job at the fruit-packing plant where she works.
A3- Because a relative and a job were waiting, the move was less risky and Montaro was the obvious choice, and now Marisol can help the next relative follow, so the chain keeps growing.

Common mistake: "Marisol moved to Montaro to get a job." True, but it doesn't show the CHAIN: no mention that her cousin was already there or found her that job.

Why the model works: It defines chain migration, uses the passage (cousin Elena, the job), and explains why that link made the move easier.

D. Explain how ONE intervening obstacle described in Stimulus 2 affects migration from Tavira to Montaro. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names an obstacle from the passage: the Brava River or the border wall
- Explains its effect (dangerous, costly, fewer people go)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- One intervening obstacle is the Brava River, a physical barrier between Tavira and Montaro.
E2- Marisol says her group crossed it at night, and people drown there every year.
A3- Because the crossing is so dangerous, the river discourages some Tavirans from leaving at all and makes the trip deadly for others, so it slows and reduces migration even though Montaro is right next door.

Common mistake: "The border is between Tavira and Montaro." It points to a location but explains nothing. Name the obstacle (the river or the wall) and explain how it makes migration harder.

Why the model works: It names an obstacle from the passage (the Brava River), uses her details (night crossing, drownings), and explains how it slows and reduces migration.

E. Using BOTH stimuli, explain ONE economic effect of remittances on Tavira. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Uses Stimulus 2: Marisol sends money home every month
- Uses Stimulus 1: many migrants work in high-income countries
- Explains an economic effect on Tavira (income, spending, schooling, businesses, dependence)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Remittances, the money migrants send home, raise household incomes in Tavira and bring money into its economy.
E2- Marisol sends money home every month so her brothers can stay in school, and Stimulus 1 shows 410,000 Tavirans moved to Montaro, a high-income country with higher wages.
A3- When hundreds of thousands of migrants send money like Marisol does, families can afford food, school, and housing, and their spending supports local businesses, though Tavira can also become dependent on money earned abroad.

Common mistake: "Marisol sends money home to her family." Only half the evidence, and no effect. Add the map's numbers and explain what the money does to Tavira's economy.

Why the model works: It uses BOTH stimuli (Marisol's monthly money, the 410,000 in high-income Montaro) and explains the effect on Tavira's incomes and spending.

F. Explain ONE way large-scale emigration, like the migration shown in Stimulus 1, can change the population structure of the origin country. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Says who leaves: young or working-age adults (or mostly men)
- Explains the change in structure (pinched pyramid, higher dependency ratio, fewer births, sex imbalance)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Large-scale emigration can leave the origin with fewer working-age adults and a higher dependency ratio, because most migrants are young adults.
E2- In 2023 alone, 600,000 people left Tavira, and migrants like 24-year-old Marisol are in their prime working and child-bearing years, so the young-adult bars of Tavira's population pyramid would shrink.
A3- With fewer workers to support children and the elderly, the dependency ratio rises, and with fewer young adults left to have children, the birth rate can fall too.

Common mistake: "Tavira's population will go down." True, but that's SIZE, not structure. Say WHO leaves (young, working-age adults) and how that changes the mix left behind.

Why the model works: It says who leaves (young adults), uses evidence (600,000 people, Marisol at 24), and explains the effect (higher dependency ratio, fewer births).

G. Explain ONE limitation of using Stimulus 1 to understand why people leave Tavira. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- States a limitation: the map shows numbers and places, not reasons
- Explains why it matters, with an example (drought, wages, violence; you'd have to guess)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- One limitation is that the flow map shows how many people left Tavira and where they went, but not WHY.
E2- It shows 410,000 people moving to Montaro, but not whether they were pushed by drought, low wages, or violence, while Stimulus 2 reveals that Marisol left because of a drought and followed her cousin.
A3- Because the map has no information about push and pull factors, someone using it alone would have to guess the causes and could get them wrong.

Common mistake: “The map doesn't show every country in the world.” That's about what's on the map, not about why people leave. Explain that the map shows numbers and places but no push or pull factors.

Why the model works: It names the limitation (no reasons), gives examples the map can't show, and explains why it matters (you'd have to guess).

Scoring guide written for the GeoArcade FRQ Tutor. Award each part independently, 1 point each.